

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Business Concept

Palmtrent is a digital marketplace connecting individuals and businesses who need transport services (Shippers) with truck owners and operators (Transporters) across Zimbabwe. We do not own trucks - we facilitate connections, ensure trust through verification, and provide tools for seamless transactions.

Core Value Proposition

For Transporters:

- **Access to consistent loads**
- **Fair and transparent pricing**
- **Verified clients and payment security**
- **Professional platform for credibility**
- **Lower empty miles through return load matching**

For Shippers:

- **Quick access to verified transporters**
- **Competitive pricing with multiple quotes**
- **Real-time GPS tracking of goods**
- **Flexible payment options (digital and cash)**
- **Insurance options for peace of mind**

For Palmtrent:

- **Commission-based revenue model**
- **Multiple income streams**
- **Scalable platform without asset ownership**
- **Regional expansion potential**

Market Opportunity

Zimbabwe's logistics sector is:

- **Fragmented and informal (no established digital platform)**
- **Cash-heavy (60-70% of economy)**
- **Growing (regional trade, agricultural exports, mining)**

- Underserved (small transporters have no access to corporate clients)
- Ready for disruption (smartphone penetration, mobile money adoption)

Unique Differentiators

1. **Payment-First Model** - No booking broadcasted before payment confirmed
 2. **Cash-Inclusive** - EcoCash agent payment option for cash users
 3. **Configurable Pricing** - All fees and commissions adjustable in real-time
 4. **Cross-Border Ready** - Comprehensive process for SADC regional trade
 5. **WhatsApp-Powered** - 98% lower data usage, reaching everyone
 6. **Zimbabwe-Built** - Designed for local infrastructure realities
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2. THE THREE-PARTY RELATIONSHIP

2.1 THE TRANSPORTER (Supply Side)

Who They Are

- Individual truck owners (bakkies to large trucks)
- Small transport companies (2-10 vehicles)
- Owner-operators with truck tractors (with/without trailers)
- Bakkie owners doing local deliveries
- Fleet owners with multiple vehicles

What They Need

- Consistent work and loads
- Fair and transparent pricing
- Payment security
- Lower empty miles (return loads)
- Professional platform for credibility
- Access to corporate clients
- Insurance options

What They Provide

- Transport services

- **Verified vehicles and documentation**
- **Professional service**
- **Real-time location tracking**
- **Proof of delivery (digital)**

Requirements to Join Platform

Mandatory Documentation:

- **Valid Driver's License (both sides scanned)**
- **Vehicle Registration Book (Blue Book)**
- **VID Certificate (Vehicle Inspection Department - current)**
- **ZINARA License (current)**
- **Insurance Certificate (minimum third-party)**
- **National ID**
- **Proof of Address**
- **Bank account or mobile money details**
- **Two references (optional but recommended)**

Vehicle Requirements:

- **Roadworthy condition**
- **Valid insurance**
- **GPS capability (smartphone for tracking)**
- **Meets load capacity claimed**

Transporter Fees

IMPORTANT: All fees and commission rates are configurable in the admin system and can be adjusted based on market conditions, promotions, or specific user agreements.

Option 1: Pay-Per-Job

- **Joining fee: USD \$20 (one-time, covers cloud infrastructure)**
- **Commission: 15% per completed job (configurable)**
- **No monthly subscription**
- **Pay commission before completing delivery**

Option 2: Basic Subscription

- **Joining fee: USD \$50 (one-time)**
- **Monthly fee: USD \$10 (configurable)**
- **Reduced commission: 12% per job (configurable)**
- **Priority in search results**

Option 3: Premium Subscription

- **Joining fee: USD \$50 (one-time)**
- **Monthly fee: USD \$25 (configurable)**
- **Reduced commission: 10% per job (configurable)**
- **Featured listings**
- **Advanced analytics**
- **Dedicated support**
- **First access to corporate contracts**

Admin Configuration Panel:

All pricing parameters (joining fees, monthly fees, commission rates, credit term surcharges) can be updated in real-time through the admin dashboard without code changes.

2.2 THE SHIPPER (Demand Side)

Who They Are

- **Individuals: Moving household goods, personal cargo**
- **SMEs: Retailers, wholesalers, small manufacturers**
- **Corporates: Large companies with regular transport needs**
- **Agricultural: Farmers, tobacco merchants, crop traders**
- **Mining: Small-scale miners, equipment suppliers**
- **Import/Export: Traders needing cross-border transport**

What They Need

- **Reliable transport (on-demand or scheduled)**
- **Competitive pricing (multiple quotes)**

- **Verified and rated transporters**
- **Real-time tracking of goods**
- **Insurance options**
- **Payment flexibility (cash and digital)**
- **Proof of delivery**

What They Provide

- **Clear load details and requirements**
- **Pickup and delivery information**
- **Payment (various methods available)**
- **Loading assistance (if agreed)**
- **Necessary permits/documentation**

Shipper Categories

Individual Shippers:

- **Sign up free**
- **Pay per booking**
- **Platform commission included in quote**
- **Optional insurance per load**

Business Accounts (SMEs):

- **Free registration**
- **Volume discounts (10+ loads/month)**
- **Invoice payment options (Net 30 days)**
 - **Credit surcharge: +3% commission (configurable)**
- **Multiple user access**
- **Booking templates for repeat routes**

Corporate Accounts:

- **Dedicated account manager**
- **Custom pricing agreements**
- **API integration available**

- **Monthly consolidated billing (Net 30-60 days)**
 - **Credit surcharge: +2-4% commission (configurable)**
- **Service level agreements (SLAs)**
- **Priority support**

Credit Terms Pricing Structure:

Payment Terms	Commission Rate
Standard Payment (Immediate)	Base commission rate
Net 30 Days	Base rate + 3% (configurable)
Net 60 Days	Base rate + 4% (configurable)
Net 90 Days	Base rate + 5% (corporate only, configurable)

Example:

- **Base transaction: USD \$1,000**
- **Standard commission (12%): USD \$120**
- **Net 30 commission (15%): USD \$150**
- **Net 60 commission (16%): USD \$160**

All credit term surcharges are configurable in the admin system and can be adjusted based on client credit rating, payment history, and market conditions.

2.3 PALMTRENT (Platform Provider)

Our Role

- **Connect transporters with shippers**
- **Verify all users (identity, documents, vehicles)**
- **Provide technology platform (app, web, USSD, WhatsApp)**
- **Facilitate payments and hold escrow**
- **Enable GPS tracking**
- **Manage ratings and reviews**
- **Resolve disputes**
- **Partner with insurance providers**

- **Ensure compliance and safety**

What We DON'T Do

- **Own or operate trucks**
- **Employ drivers**
- **Provide insurance (we facilitate through partners)**
- **Guarantee loads for transporters**
- **Guarantee specific transporters for shippers**

Our Revenue Streams

1. Transaction Commissions

- **10-15% per completed delivery (configurable)**
- **Higher for cash payments (collection risk premium)**
- **Lower for corporate volume contracts**
- **Credit term surcharges (2-5% additional)**

2. Subscription Fees

- **Transporter monthly subscriptions (USD \$10-25)**
- **Premium shipper accounts**
- **Corporate monthly retainers**

3. Insurance Referral Commissions

- **8-10% of premiums sold**
- **From partner insurance companies**
- **Both annual policies and per-shipment insurance**
- **Renewal commissions (ongoing revenue)**

4. Value-Added Services

- **Cross-border documentation assistance (USD \$50-100 per trip)**
- **Premium listings and featured placements**
- **Advanced analytics and reporting tools**
- **API integration fees**

5. Corporate Contracts

- **Setup fees (USD \$500-2,000)**
- **Monthly retainers (USD \$500-5,000)**
- **API integration fees (USD \$1,000-5,000)**
- **Dedicated account management**